

OREGON CITY COURIER

C. W. ROBEY, Editor and Business Manager

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THE STORY OF WAR

Our favorite preacher says to us, and since we love him we believe him, that the declaration of war has always had the same meaning of alarm and danger in all ages, whether among cave men, or modern savages; whether in the age of Pericles or in this brilliant 20th century. Warfare has always meant death and devastation. In its path always follows disease and famine, sorrow and devastation. The voice of the blood of Abel still cries to God from the ground for justice.

During 7000 years of history man has dealt falsely with his fellow man, and has lifted his hand against his neighbor, and human blood has stained the fields of carnage. Cruel visaged war with dripping sword and flaming torch has scourged mankind, being incited from remotest ages, not by holy purposes, but for landed possessions, for tribute money to gratify haughty vanity and for slaves.

Thus have the few jealous and sanguinary tyrants called chiefs and kings and emperors claimed a divine right over their fellows, and have fed their unholo ambitions upon the treasure and blood and liberties of mankind.

Thus have forty million of the flower of the human race poured out their blood in every century of historic time to quench the thirst of demons on the throne for riches, flattery, for ease and power. Flammarion estimates that two billion five hundred million men have perished on the fields of war since the dawn of history. Yes, the blood of Abel cries to God from the ground.

The story of war is a sad and fearful commentary on human greed and heartlessness. Wars have had their primary origins in the aggressions of haughty vanity and selfish ambition. Cain has arisen in every age, on every continent and isle of the sea to slay his brother Abel. Sometimes, thank God, Abel has been the victor. But too often Cain has triumphed and the march of progress has been blocked and recognition of the brotherhood of man has been obscured by the din and blood of battle.

The hard-fought campaigns between America and the mother country had their cause in the cruel aggressions of England. The fearful struggle between Russia and Japan had its origin in the bold aggressions of Russia upon a neighbor's territory, which threatened the national existence of Japan. War's aftermath of atrocity in the Balkans not long ago was caused by the avarice of Bulgaria in dividing the spoils of conquest, a war for territory and tribute.

But this is war of another kind. It is war for civil and religious freedom in the world. It is war for the overthrow of Cain and absolutism. Such war fulfills the noblest impulse of the human soul. Such warfare is truly glorious. Three historic scourges have devastated the world—famine, pestilence and war. But commerce conquers famine; medical science conquers pestilence; and what will ever conquer war?

It will be justice, common sense and a strong arm that will conquer war. May the holy power of all lovers of liberty and haters of absolutism unite in a mighty arm to strike down the demon and usher the nations of the earth into their heritage of democratic freedom.

THE GREATER WAR

A war more vicious, more grim, yet, withal, more worthy than any battles in the world's history, is the war for the human soul. It is a war of salvation and preservation while our other wars are of destruction, tearing down the ramparts of civilization that the minds of twenty centuries have labored to build up.

This war for souls has not been one wonderful chain of victories. It has included defeats that have made millions of hearts bleed in the very agony of it. Only last week did the war for souls score another defeat for one of its armies. The Human Soul Development corporation of Detroit closed

its books and marked "failure" over its portals. The corporation failed and in the accounting its only asset was a little girl—somebody's daughter, somebody's sister—an outcast, a human derelict traveling the thorny pathway of pain in the underworld of a big city.

Man's mind has a greater work to do than to invent means of destroying life. It has before it the task of culling sin from the hearts of humanity, and until such a time as the Human Soul Development corporation could have no cause for existence, there will be warfare in the universe and hate in the minds of men. Until such a time God's will on earth cannot be known and peace and plenty will be but the mocking signals of a destiny unfound, of a life problem unsolved.

The Human Soul Development corporation was organized to redeem the soul of a waif, a plodder along the highway of ease, aged 17 years. Four men with human souls organized themselves to reclaim this pretty outcast tainted by men with unhuman souls, with animal hearts and filthy minds. But the corporation failed and the primrose path shouted victory in a greater battle than any that soldiers ever fought.

The corporation attempted to educate the little girl who was walking off the beaten path of honor. They sent her to Canada and placed her in school. She prospered and her mind threw off the fog that fate had wrapped it in. She made friends—she knew the joy of life. Then her story came to the ears of her new "friends." Turned up noses and shrugged shoulders greeted the little woman. "Friends" colored anew the rose of shame in her tresses. The girl again became an outcast, a nomad in a life of sin. She lost her fight and the Human Soul corporation went out of business. Its members found their only asset, a tender young girl, weeping in the misery of her dependence in the underworld of a great city. She would not return to the scorn of the upper world; she preferred the misery, the tears and the heart aches of her sin to the sin of her betters in scorning her for her folly.

The greatest hero the world will ever know will be the man or the union of forces that will be able again to open the books of the Human Soul Development corporation and other agencies for the salvation of souls who are compelled to seek the "easiest way" to escape the torments of an unequal social organization, and having opened the books can keep them open until the great war for souls shall replace failure with victory throughout the world.

BANK ASSETS

American national banks have set a new high record for resources, again revealing the United States as incomparably the richest nation in the world.

Comptroller Williams announced that on March 5, the date of the last bank call, the assets of the national banks aggregated more than \$16,000,000,000, exceeding by over \$5,000,000 the combined resources of the Bank of England, the Bank of France, the Bank of Italy, the Bank of Spain, the Bank of Norway, the Bank of Sweden, the Swiss national bank, the national bank of Denmark, the Bank of Japan and the Reichs Bank of Germany.

"Reports of national banks in the central reserve cities and reserve cities throughout the country as of March 5, just compiled," said the Comptroller's statement, "show that on that date the resources of these banks were \$210,000,000 larger than ever before in their history, the previous highwater mark having been reached November 17, 1916. The increase, as compared with December 27, 1916, was \$480,000,000.

"The reports have thus far been compiled for only about one-fifth of the country banks, or banks outside of the reserve cities. If the assets of the other country banks have increased at the same rate as thus far compiled the total increase in coun-

try bank resources will be approximately \$250,000,000 as compared with December 27.

"On this basis the increase in the resources of all national banks in central reserve and reserve cities and country banks from December 27 to March 5 will approximate \$730,000,000, making the total assets of all national banks March 5 considerably in excess of \$16,000,000,000.

"As the total resources of all national banks on April 4, 1918, amounted to only \$11,081,000,000, the increase of resources for the past four years has amounted to approximately \$5,000,000,000.

"The amount of bonds of foreign governments and of other securities held by our national banks on March 5 was approximately \$338,000,000, or but little more than 2 per cent of their total resources. The increase, as compared with December 27, was \$16,000,000 and as compared with November 17 was \$40,000,000."

PLENTY OF CORN

An agricultural expert remarks that, war or no war, there is no reason why the American people should go hungry. Even in case of a prolonged conflict, we should have no such food problem to face as that of the European belligerents. There may not be enough wheat, there may not be enough potatoes, but there is always plenty of corn. "King Corn" may be our salvation, says The Dallas Chronicle.

It is our greatest farm crop. We raise nearly all the corn grown in the world. Our production amounts to about 3,000,000,000 bushels a year, 30 bushels for every man, woman and child of us, about 150 bushels to the average family. If you doubt whether the United States could stand a prolonged siege, just stop and figure whether your family could eat 150 bushels of corn in a year—half a bushel a day.

Corn is a food of great nourishing power. It is practically as wholesome as wheat, and when properly prepared it is just as palatable. We commonly regard it as food for animals rather than man, but that is mere habit and prejudice. It is one of the finest human foods ever given mankind by bountiful nature. It is nature's special gift to America.

We can raise enormous quantities of corn with comparatively little effort. We can easily produce more than 3,000,000,000 bushels a year if we set about it seriously and our great corn lands lie far inland, beyond any possible peril of invading enemies.

It isn't necessary, as yet, to start living on a corn diet. But the knowledge that we could do so, if necessary, ought to give us a better appreciation of this cereal and a keener desire to get acquainted—or renew our acquaintance—with the many delectable forms in which it graces American tables.

A FAIR ASSURANCE

The following statement made by the department of state of Washington should set at ease those few foreigners in America who, not seeing beyond the horizon of their own little imaginations, fear that the government of the United States will be so small as to attempt to make capital of a state of war and hereby deprive honest citizens of their honest gains or holdings.

"It having been reported that there is anxiety in some quarters on the part of persons residing in this country who are subjects of foreign states, lest their bank deposits or other property should be seized in the event of war between the United States and a foreign nation, the president authorizes the statement that all such fears are entirely unfounded. The government of the United States will on no circumstances take advantage of a state of war to take possession of property in which international understandings and the recognized law of the land give it no just claim or title. It will scrupulously respect all private rights alike of its own citizens and of the subjects of foreign states."

INQUIRY ANSWERED

Highway Commission Will Build Own Plant if Necessary

In reply to an inquiry from the legislative good roads committee as to what its policy would be in the matter of awarding contracts for road construction if the pending road bill should be approved by the voters at the June election, the state highway commission issued the following statement:

"We recognize the propriety of your inquiry and therefore hereby authorize you on our behalf to say that this commission, at a public meeting held at Portland on this date, adopted the following resolution:

"Whereas there exists in the public mind an impression that undue profits have heretofore been made by paving contractors in Oregon, and it is resolved that it will be the policy of the highway commission to call for bids on all standard types of pavement in open and fair competition and to award contracts to the lowest responsible bidder, who will be required to give a good and sufficient guarantee for the permanency of his work.

"Be it further resolved that in the event no satisfactory bid can be obtained the highway commission will proceed to do the work itself by force account after the purchase and installation of its own paving plant."

How's This?

We offer One Hundred Dollars Reward for any case of Catarrh that cannot be cured by Hall's Catarrh Medicine. Hall's Catarrh Medicine has been taken by catarrh sufferers for the past thirty-five years, and has become known as the most reliable remedy for Catarrh. Hall's Catarrh Medicine acts thru the Blood on the Mucous surfaces, expelling the Poison from the Blood and healing the diseased portions. After you have taken Hall's Catarrh Medicine for a short time you will see a great improvement in your general health. Start taking Hall's Catarrh Medicine at once and get rid of catarrh. Send for testimonials free. F. J. CHENEY & CO., Toledo, Ohio. Sold by all Druggists, etc.

The above resolution is intended as a frank statement to the public of what our policy will be. If there is anything which is not fully covered it is due to an oversight on our part and not due to any desire to evade any issue or question.

We may summarize our plans as follows: "We shall demand and endeavor to acquire for the state full value for every dollar of public money expended. If the bond issue is adopted we shall, as far as possible, commence work in every county in which work is to be done at the earliest possible moment. We shall not favor one county or locality over another, but will, to the best of our ability, be fair to the various sections of the state."

Daughter in Terrible Shape

Women bear troubles more bravely than men. They smile and suffer pain uncomplainingly where a man demands a doctor and nurse. A. Mitchell, Bagdad, Ky., writes: "My daughter was in terrible shape with kidney trouble. I got her to take Foley Kidney Pills and she is completely cured." Aching back, sore muscles, stiff joints, shooting pains in sides, rheumatic aches, are indications that the kidneys are not working properly. Foley Kidney Pills correct bladder troubles.—Jones Drug Co.

NATIONAL DEFENSE

Agreement Proposed for Employers to Sign. Officer Points to Duty

Col. C. E. Dentler, U. S. A., who spoke at Bunch's hall on last Thursday evening, has prepared the following agreement which he and many others urge employers of labor to sign. Portland employers have responded splendidly to the request that such an agreement be made and it is proposed that the same thing be submitted in Oregon City:

Now, when our country is facing the early probability of war, every able-bodied young man, between the ages of 18 and 35, should be in training to serve his country by joining the national guard, the naval militia, or the regular army or navy.

We believe that in our country the duties of citizenship devolve equally upon all citizens. Therefore those citizens who take upon themselves the difficult and dangerous task of performing the military duty of the country are thereby performing that duty for all who do not so serve their country.

Therefore, we, citizens of Oregon and of the United States, do hereby pledge ourselves, and we do guarantee unto each and every one of our employees who serves his country by enlistment in the national guard or the naval militia that he shall not by reason of such service be placed in jeopardy of the loss of his job. And that we will hold his job for him, with full pay during temporary absence, such as guard duty, or summer encampment; and in case he is taken away for a longer period by orders from proper military authority, so that we are obliged to fill his place, we will take him back again when he returns.

CARNIVAL POSTPONED

Unfavorable Weather for Training Causes Shift of Date of Meet

Bad weather conditions have caused the big indoor relay carnival of the Oregon Agricultural college to be postponed until April 21. This interschool and inter-college track and field meet was scheduled for April 7, but so many requests for postponement reached the college athletic department that the delay was necessary in order to give the competing teams an opportunity to select their representatives and put them into shape for the contest. The management is assured that the postponement will result in increased interest and attendance.

All of the Oregon colleges, the state university, the university and the state college of Washington and the university of Idaho, will send athletes to the carnival. All the preparatory schools of the valley, the Portland high schools, the Lewis & Clark and North Central of Spokane, and the Vancouver schools will be represented.

The Drill with the Feed that CAN'T Sow Wrong

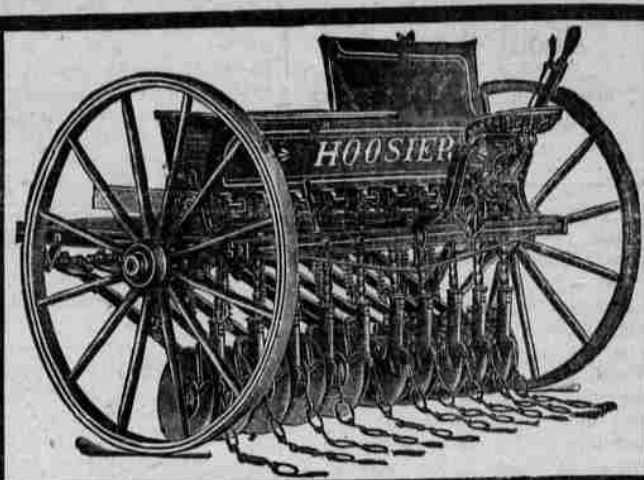
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PUPILS DECLAIM

Milwaukie Scene of Annual Contest. Prizes are Awarded

Before a large audience at Milwaukie on Saturday evening, the annual Clackamas county grammar school declamatory contest was held under the direction of Brenton Vedder, school supervisor and director of the county school league. Three of the four prizes offered were awarded to girls and one to a boy.

In the contest 23 schools were represented by as many speakers. Prizes were awarded as follows: Velma Randall, Eastham; second, June Madison, Wichita; third, Nethi Westergard, Oswego, and fourth, Margaret Coleman, Clackamas. Judges of the contest were L. H. Morgan, principal of the Sellwood school; W. McNulty principal at Gladstone, and Carl S. Anderson, principal at Aurora.

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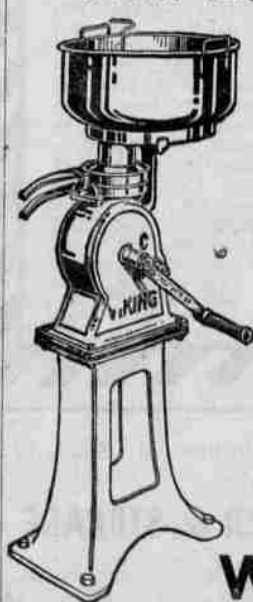
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